Based on the recommendations made by the above committees and commissions, various reforms have been introduced from time to time in our electoral system. Let us have a look at them.

- Lowering the voting age from 21 to 18 through the 61st amendment act of 1988.
- Officers, and staff engaged in preparation, revision and correction of electoral rolls for elections to be on deputation to the Election commission.
- Increase of number of proposers to 10% of the electors of the constituency or 10 electors, whichever is less.
- In 1989, a provision was made to facilitate the use of electronic voting machines in elections.
- In 1989, a provision was made for adjournment of poll in case of booth capturing.
- Listing the name of candidates as candidates of recognised political parties, candidates of registered–unrecognized political parties and other(independent) candidates.
- Prohibition on the sale of liquor within a polling area during the period of 48 hours ending with the hour fixed for the conclusion of poll.
- On the death of a contesting candidate, the party concerned would be given an option to propose another candidate within 7 days.
- The registered voters are entitled for a paid holiday on the polling day.
- Prohibition of arms.
- In 1998 a provision was made whereby the employees of local authorities, nationalized banks, universities, LIC, government undertakings and other government aided institutions can be requisitioned for deployment on election day.
- In 1999, a provision was made for voting by certain classes of persons through postal ballot.
- In 2003, the facility to opt for voting through proxy was provided to the service voters belonging to the armed forces and members belonging to a force to which provisions of the Army Act apply.
- In 2003, the Election commission issued an order for the declaration of criminal antecedents, assets etc.
- In 2003, Rajya Sabha elections were reformed by removing the domicile of the contesting candidate and further introduction of open ballot system was introduced.
- In 2003, an exemption of travelling expenditure from being included in the election expenses of the candidate was made.
- Free supply of electoral rolls by the government.
- In 2009, restrictions were imposed on conducting exit polls and publishing the results of exit polls.
- In 2009, a provision was made for the disqualification of a person found guilty of corrupt practices which provided for a three month time limit within which the specified authority will have to submit the case of the person found to be guilty.

11th Std Political Science Eng Medium Vol-2_Chapter 11.indd 213 2/6/2020 2:08:18 PM